Yeadon Demographics

Populations and Demographics:

Yeadon Borough is located in Delaware County in Pennsylvania State and borders the city of Philadelphia. The borough falls within three census tracts: 4021, 4022, and 4023. In 2021, Yeadon had a population of 11,945 (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). Yeadon has seen slow population growth over the last decade. Since 2011, the population only grew by 484. While the overall population remained similar, we observed notable changes in the age distribution among the population (Figure 1). There was an 8.8 percentage point and a 7.9 percentage point decrease in the population under 24 years old and 35 to 54 years old, respectively, between 2011 and 2021. On the other hand, Yeadon's population aged 55 years and over experienced a 10.8 percentage point increase. This signifies that the city's population is aging and likely attractive to older residents. The changes in the demographic composition also suggest that Yeadon might not be an attractive location for families with school-aged children.

Additionally, Yeadon Borough has a majority Black or African American population, making up 90.3% of its population in 2021 (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). This suggests that Yeadon has the potential to become an important cultural center for the large African American population in the area. Moreover, Yeadon Borough is located in close proximity to West Philadelphia, an area with a large African American and Black population.

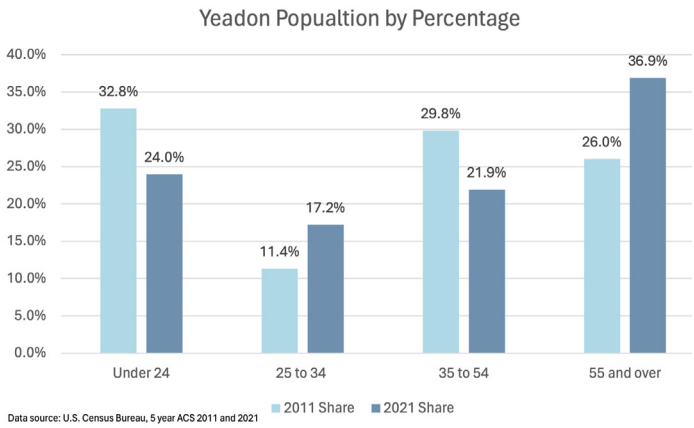


Figure 1: Yeadon's Population Composition in 2011 and 2021

Occupancy and Housing Type:

In 2021, there was a total of 5,241 dwelling units in Yeadon Borough, an 8-unit increase since 2011 (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). The marginal increase in total housing mirrors the marginal increase in population during this period. Yeadon's vacancy rate is 5.3%, much lower than the county and national rates of 6.2% and 10.1%, respectively (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). This suggests that there is demand for housing in Yeadon. However, the low net development could potentially impede Yeadon's population growth.

Although Yeadon's new dwelling units only increased by eight units, we observed changes in housing types between 2011 and 2021. Figure 2 illustrates the significant decrease of 993 1-unit detached homes in Yeadon from 2011 to 2021. The drop in the number of detached homes was replaced by constructing 1-unit attached, 2-unit homes, and 3- or 4-unit homes. This signifies that there has been some densification within Yeadon as there is a rise in denser development types.

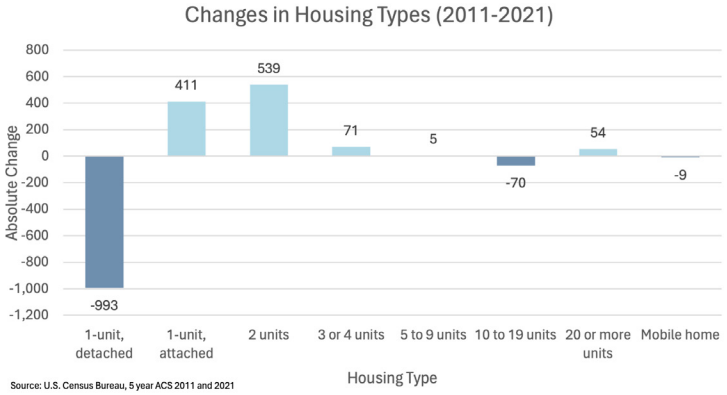


Figure 2: Changes in Housing Type in Yeadon Borough between 2011 and 2021

Attached homes seen in Yeadon

Housing and Affordability:

In 2021, the median household income in Yeadon was $55,988 (Figure 3). This was well below the county and state median of $80,398 and $92,849, respectively (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). A low median household income may suggest Yeadon residents may be vulnerable to financial stressors. Considerable expenditures typically include housing and transportation costs. Currently, a large proportion of Yeadon's population are renters. In 2021, 48.3% of homes were renter-occupied (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). This is a significant shift from the housing patterns observed in 2011, where only 33.9% of homes were renter-occupied (U.S. Census Bureau 2011).

With such a significant proportion of Yeadon's population being renters, we looked into the rent burden. The U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) defines rent burden as a household spending more than 30% of its household income on housing (Larrimore and Schuetz 2017). Following HUD's definition, we categorized the households' degree of rent burden by the percentage of income spent on housing.

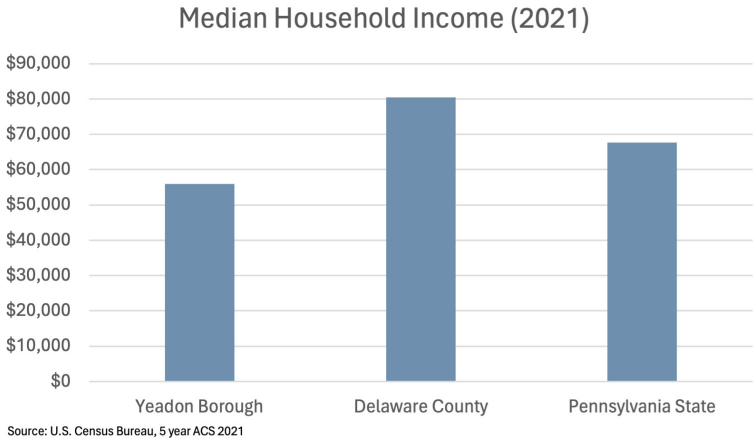


Figure 3: Median Household Income in 2021 in Yeadon, Delaware County, and Pennsylvania State

Households that spend more than 30% of household income on housing are considered rent-burdened, 20% to 29.9% are considered moderately burdened, and less than 19.9% are not rent-burdened. Figure 5 shows the breakdown of rent-burdened households in Yeadon. In 2021, 39% of households were rent-burdened, with 709 households spending 35% or more of their household income on housing. The share of households experiencing some degree of the rental cost burden is concerning. This suggests that a significant proportion of Yeadon residents are financially vulnerable to housing displacement.

Affordability is a crucial issue that should be addressed in Yeadon. While affordability may be subjective based on location, the H+T index, published by the Center for Neighborhood Technology, has designed perimeters to determine how much households should spend on housing and transportation based on locality. In Yeadon, all households' expenditures for housing and transportation exceed 24% of household income, with 76.6% of households spending between 36% and 45% of their income (Center for Neighborhood Technology, n.d.). This finding suggests that affordability impacts a majority of Yeadon residents. As we consider enhancing Yeadon, we must consider equitable development that will improve the lives of existing residents.

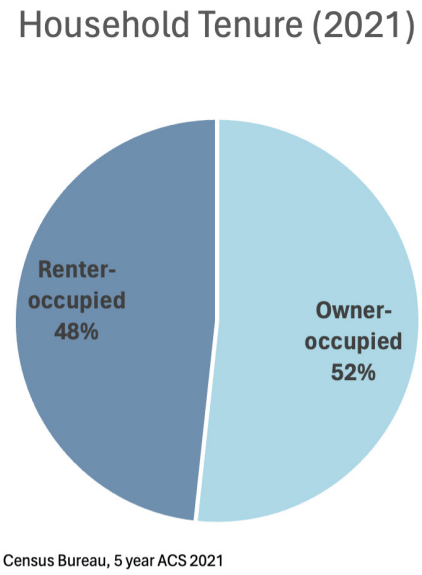


Figure 4: Household Tenure-type Breakdown in Yeadon in 2021

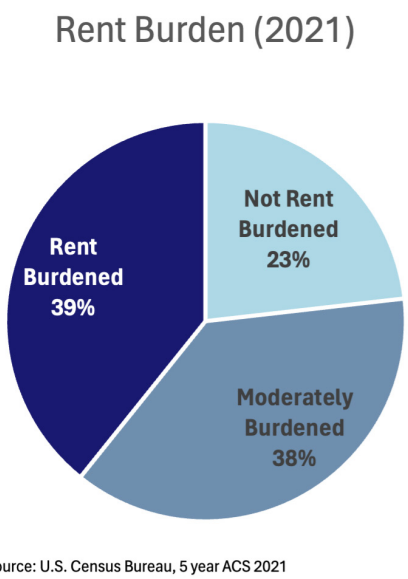


Figure 5: Rent Burden Breakdown in Yeadon in 2021

Vulnerable Populations:

Some populations are more vulnerable to financial insecurity than others. Moverover, magnitude and impact of financial stability can be greater for families with children. This challenge is heightened for single-parent households that typically rely on the support of a single income stream.

The proportion of Yeadon's single-mother population is significantly higher than the county and state proportion. In 2021, 10.0% of Yeadon's households were single-mother families, while the county and state share were 6.0% and 4.8%, respectively. Financial insecurity is a concern for single-parent households as essential expenses can accumulate quickly. According to Feeding America,

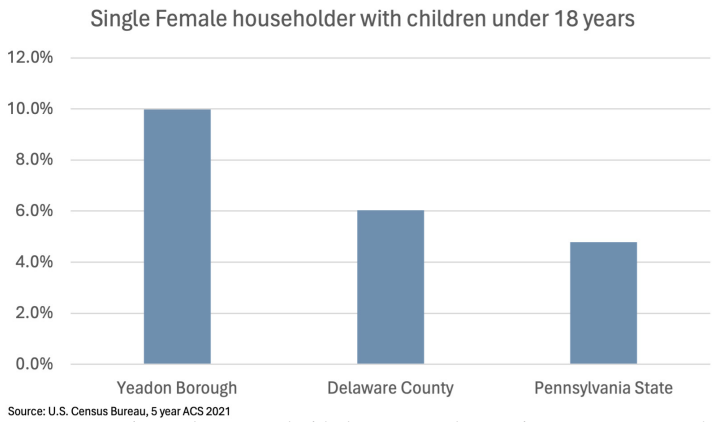
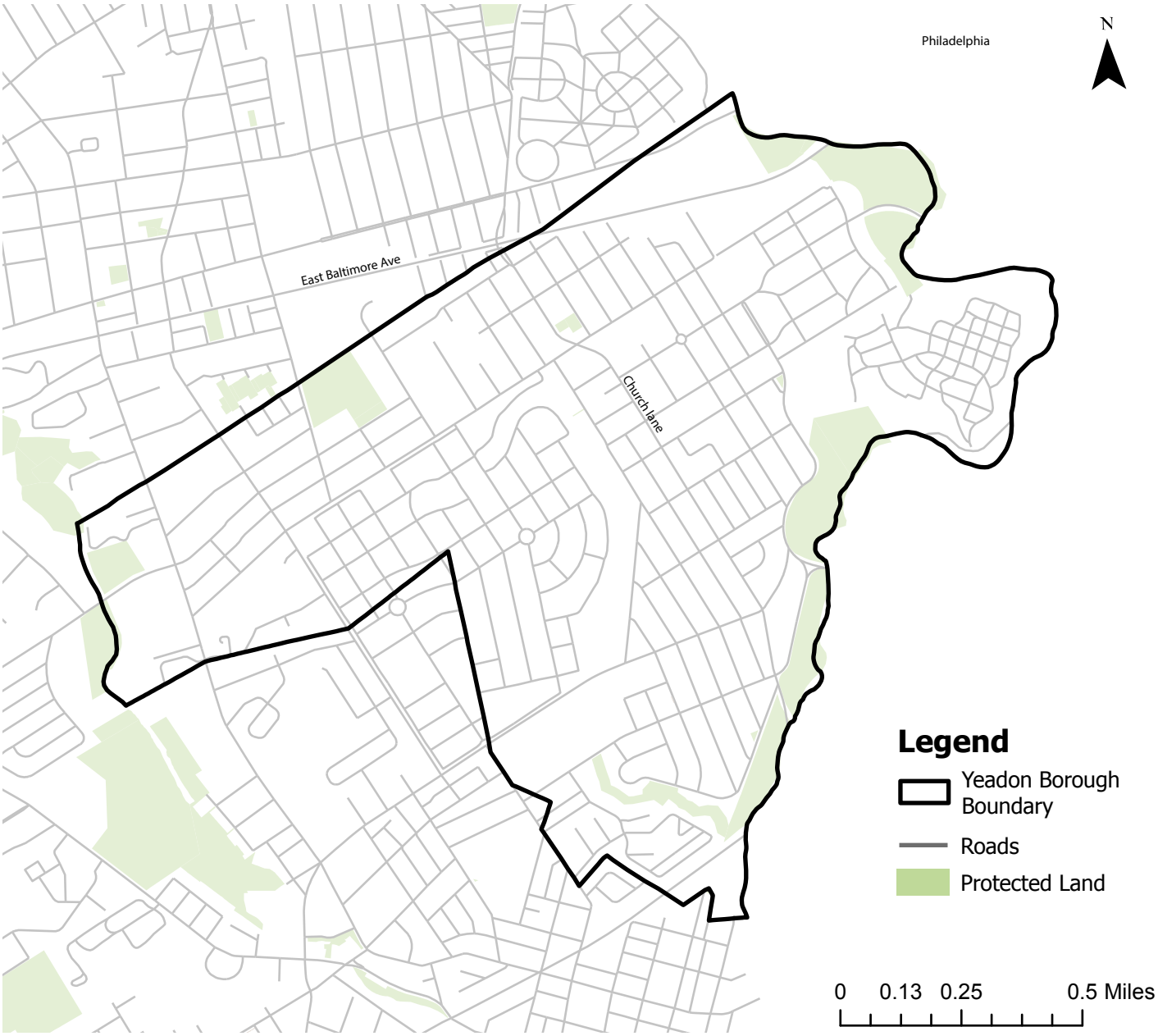


Figure 6: Single-mother Household Share in Yeadon, Delaware County, and Pennsylvania State



Base Map of Yeadon Borough

single-parent households are more likely to experience food insecurity. In 2022, 33% of single-mother households experienced food insecurity (Feeding America, n.d.). Considering that Yeadon has a high proportion of single-mother households, it is likely that the national rate of food insecurity experienced by single-mother households is similar to Yeadon's, if not higher.

Food Insecurity:

The ability to afford food is crucial for our livelihoods. The U.S. Department of Agriculture defines food security as the ability to access "enough food for an active, healthy life" (USDA 2023). In 2021, 16.4% of households in Yeadon relied on Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits to supplement their diets (U.S. Census Bureau 2021). This was higher than the county and state rates of 12.5% and 13.4%, respectively. Yeadon's higher rates of SNAP enrollment may suggest that larger proportions of households face food insecurity. Moreover, SNAP enrollment is typically lower than the demand for food assistance. This may suggest that more households are at risk of or are experiencing food insecurity.